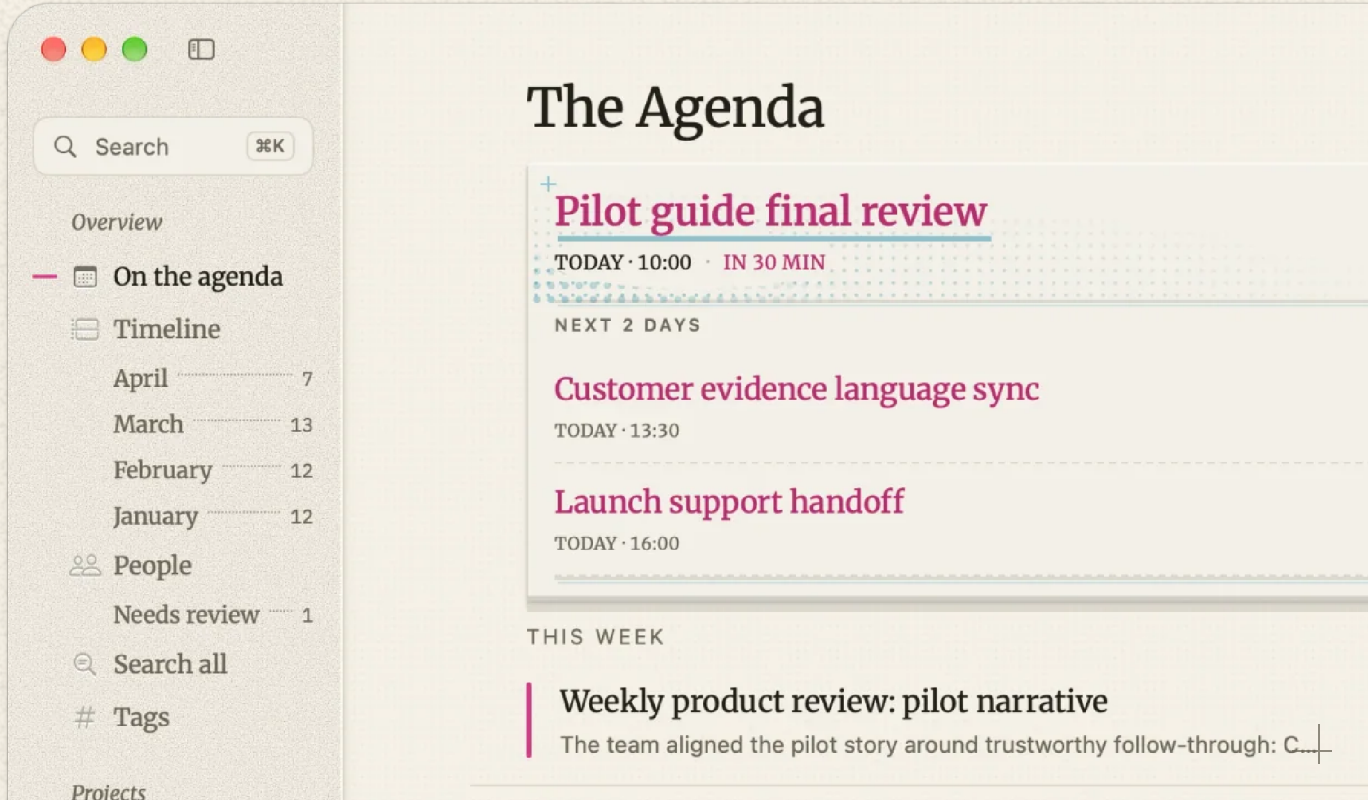
GRØD, for the Product Practice · October 2026

Meetings, distilled.

A Mac app that remembers your meetings. I built it for me.

Alex Holley

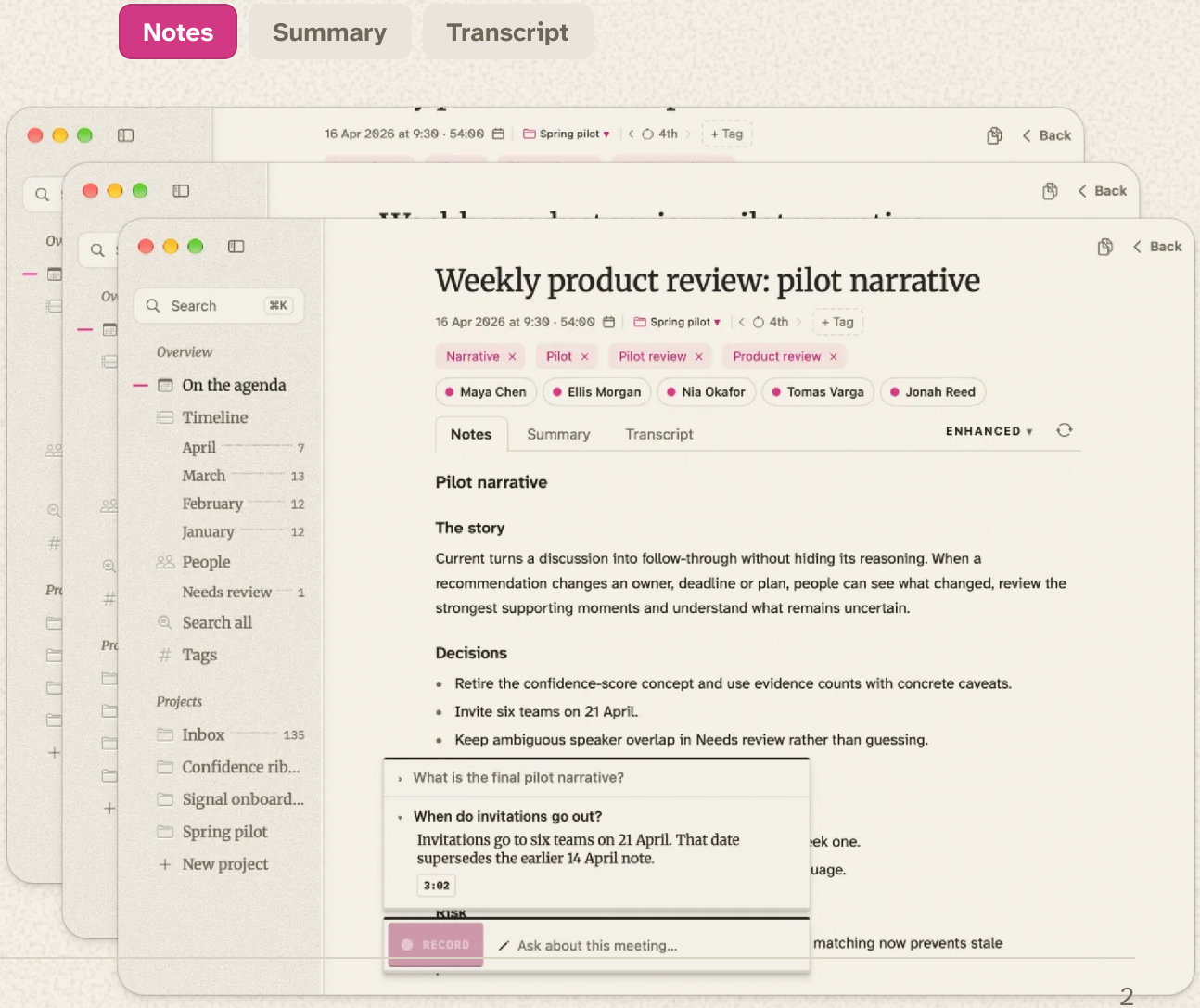


What it is

It remembers what was said, who said it, and what you decided.

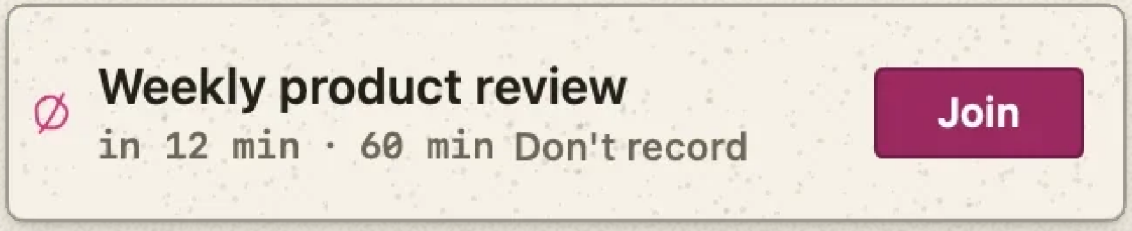
GRØD records both sides of your calls and writes the summary and the notes, all of it on your Mac.

No bot joins the call, and there's no account or server.

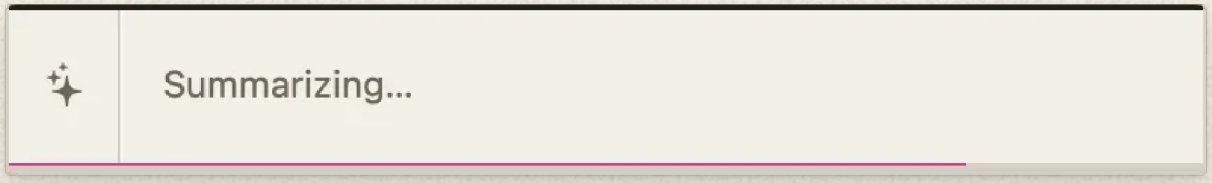


Before, during, after

It handles the day without joining your call.



Before. A card ahead of each scheduled meeting, with Join and a quiet way to skip recording that one.



After. It transcribes, names the speakers and writes the notes, and says which step it is on.

During. A pill on the edge of your screen shows the time and the state. There's no bot in the participant list.

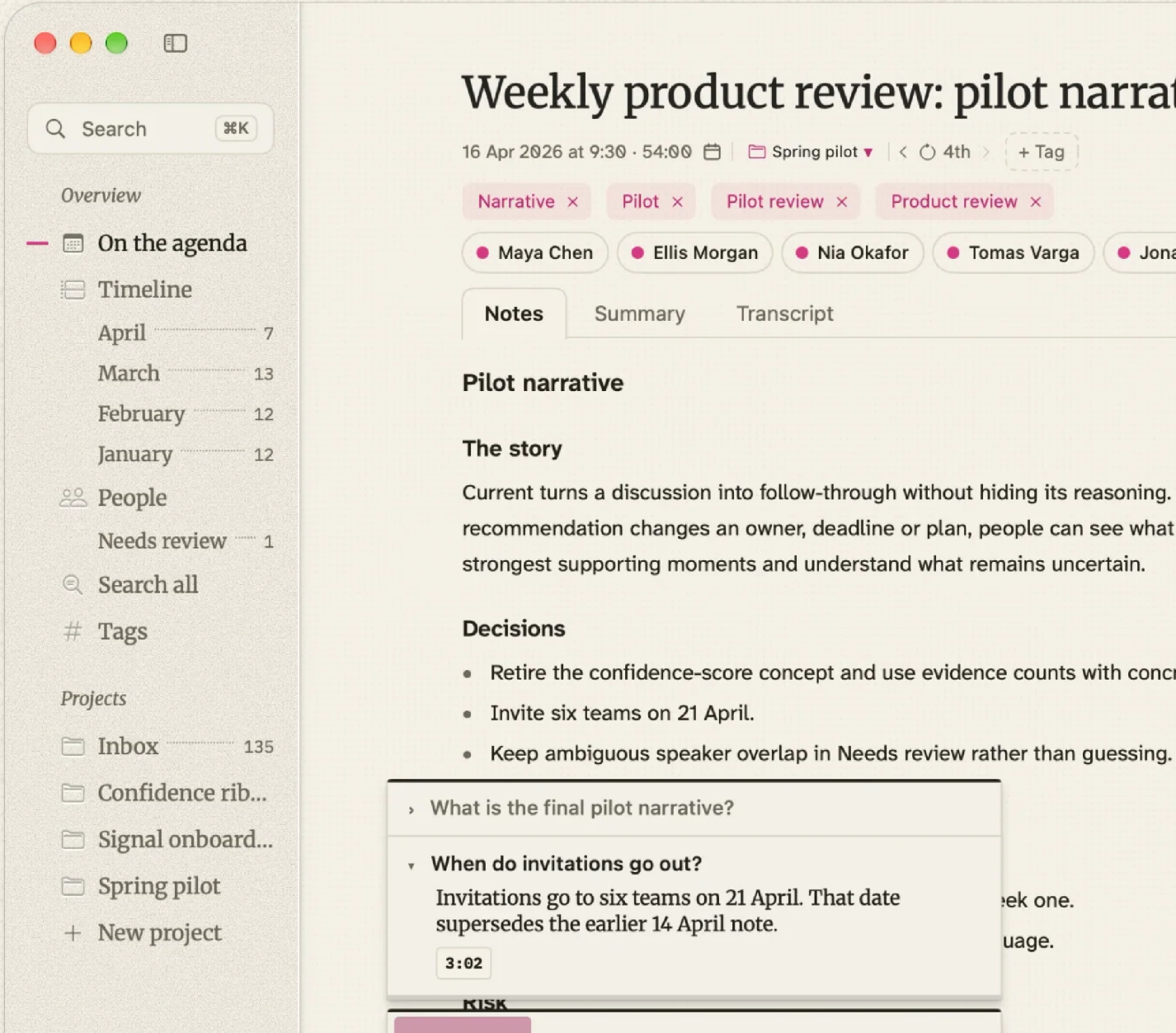


The hour after

It writes around your notes, not over them.

Type what matters in the meeting. Afterwards GRØD keeps your lines exactly as you wrote them and builds the rest around them.

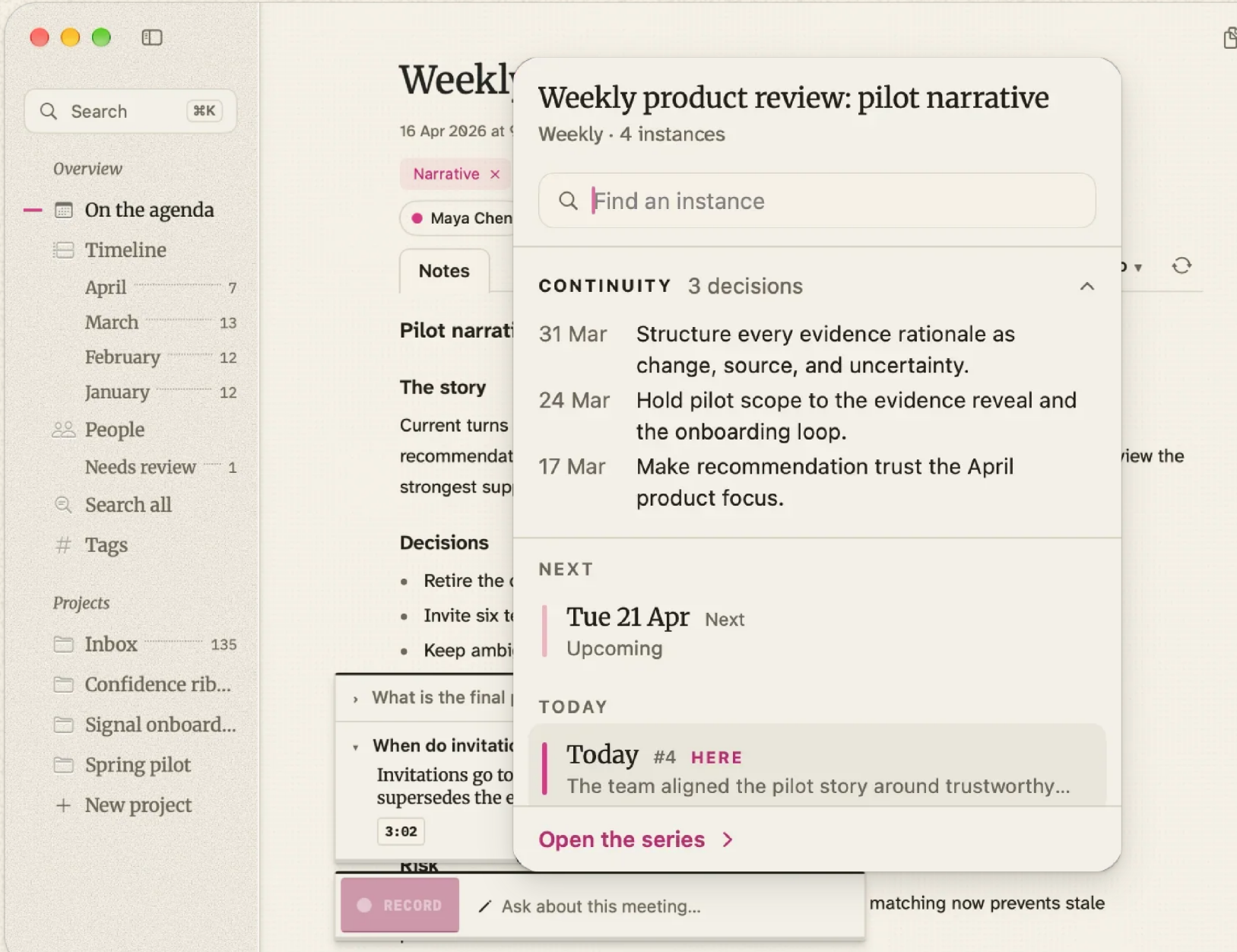
The summary is yours too: reword a decision, tick an action or change an owner, and Regenerate keeps your edits.

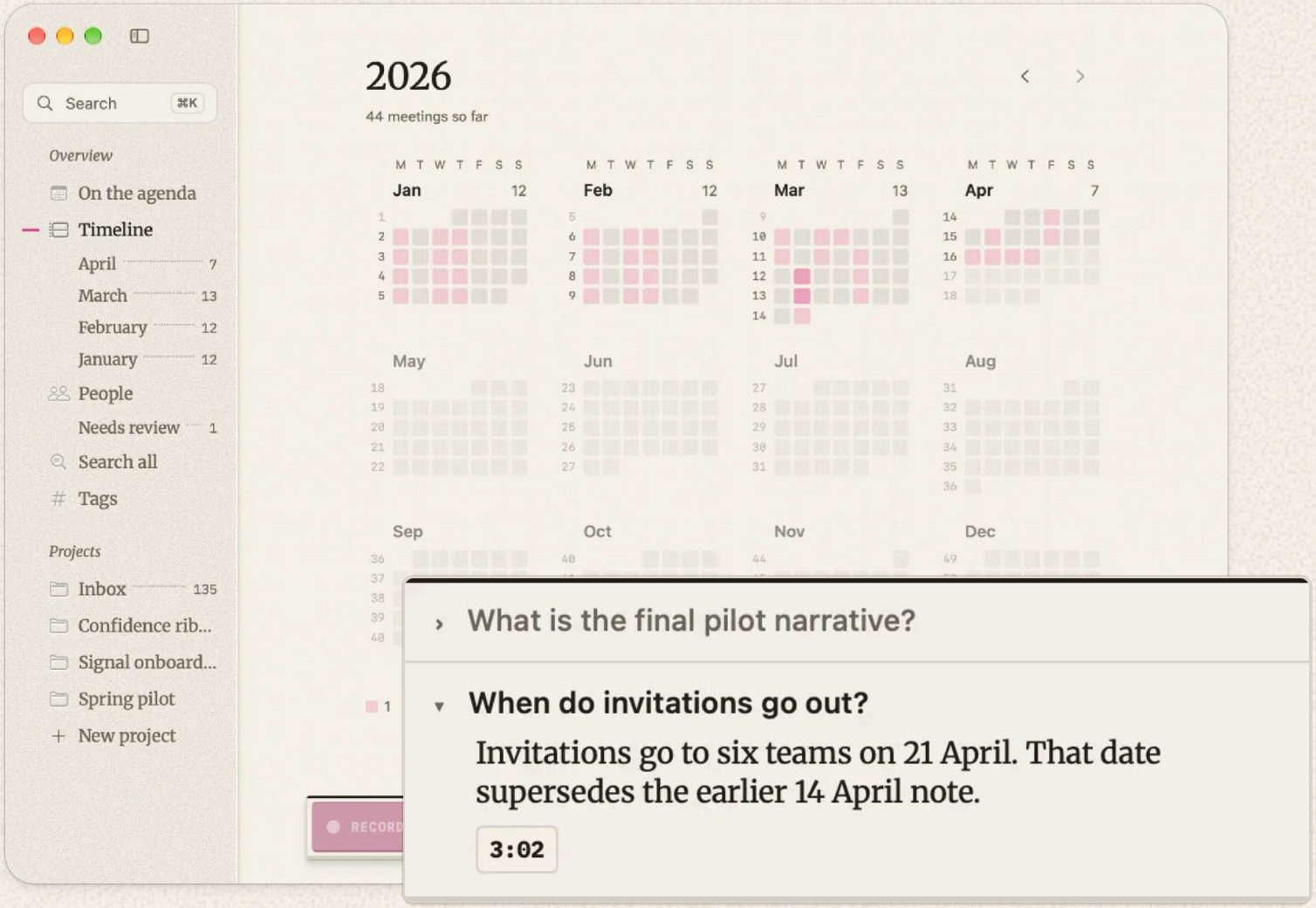


The week after

Your weekly review is one thing across time.

Open any meeting in a series and the decisions from the last few are right there, dated.





The year after

A year on one page. Ask across all of it.

⌘K finds a meeting by its words or by what was meant. An answer comes with its source, and GRØD says so when a meeting did not cover something.

Why I built it

Your notes are your notes.

I don’t believe you should pay someone a monthly fee to get to your own notes. So GRØD runs on the Mac you already have, and keeps everything there.

No account

Nothing to sign in to.

No server

Not for sync, not for analytics.

No subscription

No servers to pay for, so nothing to rent.

The decision that made it possible, day one

The best decision was a constraint.

I chose
macOS 26 and Apple silicon only

→ So
macOS brings the speech and language models

→ So
Nothing to download when you install

→ So
No server to run

→ So
No subscription to justify

What it cost

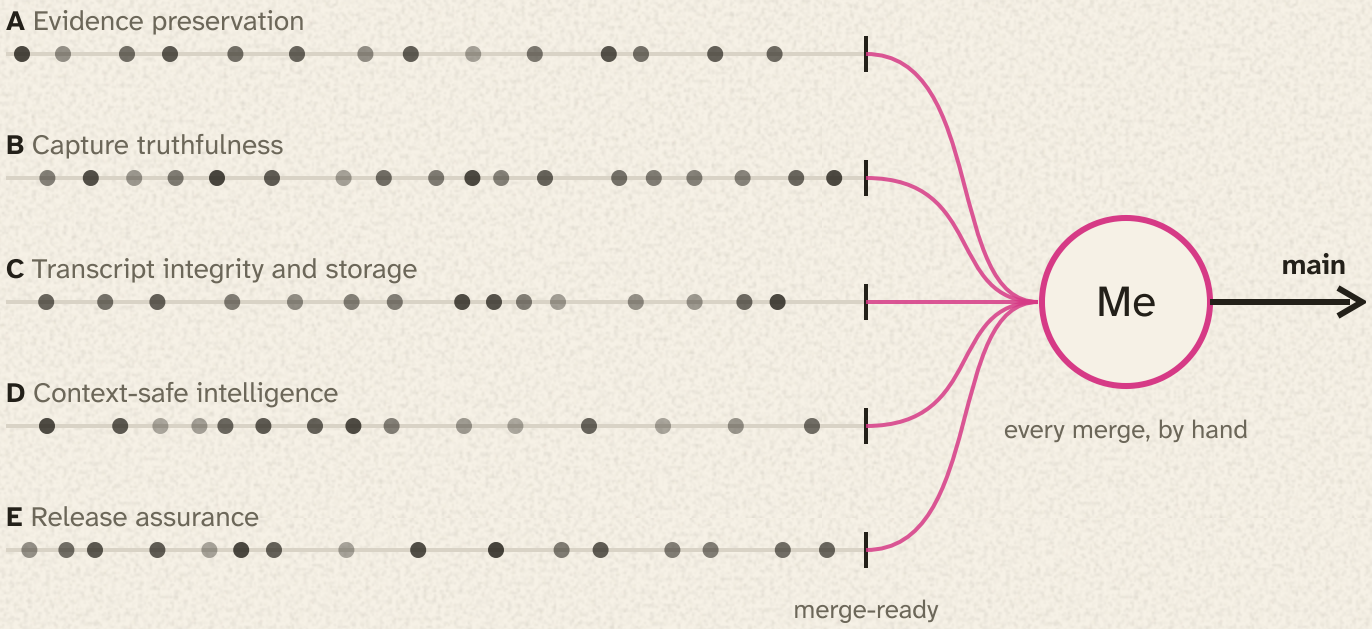
Fewer people can run it. I chose that on day one and wrote it down.

What it bought

No monthly fee, and a privacy claim you can check, because the default install downloads nothing.

How it was built

One PM, agents in lanes, every merge by hand.



- Building got cheap, so my job became the order of things: what has to be true first, and what can run side by side.
- The merge gate was worth more than the parallelism.
- Tests became what I reviewed: 153,000 lines of them, against 106,000 lines of product.

Swift and SwiftUI on Apple's SpeechAnalyzer and Foundation Models, FluidAudio for voices. Agents: Claude Code and Codex. Tickets in Linear.

What I learned

Three things I'd bring to any team.

A release bar

Write the bar as a sentence.

"Never loses a meeting, and a stranger can install it." It has settled real arguments since 25 July. A percentage would have started them.

Receipt It is why onboarding blocks the release.

A record

Write down why, not what.

A changelog says what changed. My decision log keeps the arguments, including the ones that lost, so anyone can rebuild the call or overturn it when the facts change.

Receipt decisions.md, 427 entries

A deletion

Deleting a feature takes proof it's dead.

Quick Peek was shipped, liked and named in the spec. A known bug in it sat unfixed for weeks and nobody noticed, because nobody used it.

Receipt decisions.md, 5 August

15 July to 20 October

Ninety-eight days.

3,606
commits

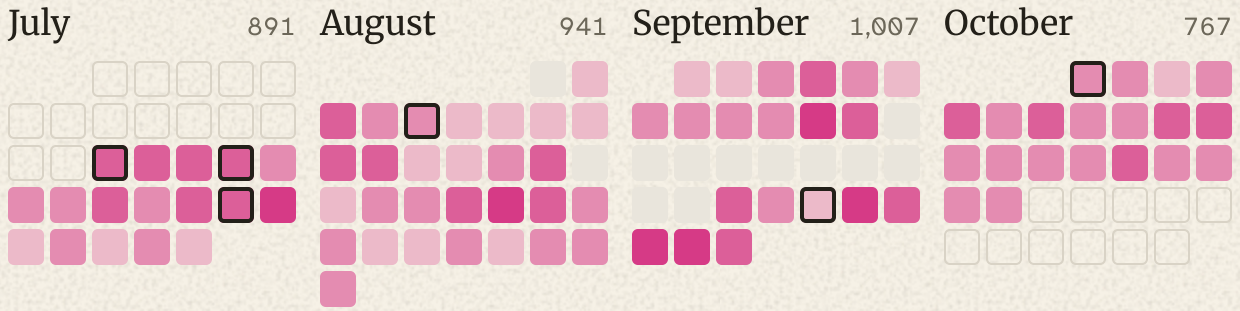
305
pull requests, merged by hand

6,000+
tests

427
decisions written down, with why

1
feature deleted on purpose

0
servers



Fewer more commits a day a moment in the story

15 Jul First commit
18 Jul The promise breaks
25 Jul The 1.0 bar
5 Aug Quick Peek deleted
25 Sep 0.6 on TestFlight
1 Oct The site goes live

Try it

Breakfast is ready.

GRØD is on TestFlight now. If you have a Mac with Apple silicon and macOS 26, it's yours to try.

Join the TestFlight beta

testflight.apple.com/join/pufKwmNU

Scan to join the beta



GRØD